



ST. ANN'S COLLEGE FOR WOMEN

Run by The Society of St Anne

Affiliated to Acharya Nagarjuna University, Approved by AICTE

Recognised under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act 1956, New Delhi.

Accredited by NAAC with 'A' Grade in the first cycle

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Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) / Anti-Sexual Harassment Committee

Guidelines & Procedures

1. Introduction

The Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) / Anti-Sexual Harassment Committee of St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur is constituted in accordance with the provisions of the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 (POSH Act), UGC Regulations, and NAAC quality guidelines.

The committee is committed to creating and maintaining a safe, secure, respectful, and gender-sensitive campus environment free from sexual harassment, discrimination, and any form of misconduct. The committee works to ensure dignity, equality, and well-being of women students, teaching staff, and non-teaching staff within the institution.

2. Objectives

The objectives of the Internal Complaints Committee are to:

- Prevent sexual harassment and gender-based discrimination within the campus.
- Create awareness regarding women's rights, safety, and gender sensitivity.
- Conduct educational and awareness programs on prevention of sexual harassment.
- Provide a safe platform for reporting complaints related to harassment.
- Ensure timely and fair redressal of complaints received.
- Promote a respectful and inclusive institutional environment.
- Address issues related to the well-being of women students and women employees.
- Organize expert talks, counseling sessions, and health awareness programs.
- Maintain confidentiality and dignity of complainants during enquiry proceedings.

3. Definition of Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment includes any unwelcome act or behavior, whether direct or implied, such as:

- Physical contact and advances
- Demand or request for sexual favors
- Sexually colored remarks
- Showing pornography or offensive material
- Unwelcome verbal, non-verbal, or physical conduct of sexual nature
- Online harassment, stalking, bullying, or intimidation
- Any conduct affecting dignity, safety, or academic/work environment

4. Constitution of the Committee

The Internal Complaints Committee shall consist of:

- Principal – Chairperson
- Senior Woman Faculty Member – Presiding Officer
- Faculty Representatives
- Non-Teaching Staff Representative
- Student Representatives (where appropriate)
- External Member from NGO / Legal / Women Welfare Organization
- Counselor / Medical Expert (if required)

The committee shall be constituted as per UGC and POSH Act norms.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

The committee shall:

- Conduct awareness and educational programs on prevention of sexual harassment.
- Create awareness about legal provisions and women safety measures.
- Receive and redress complaints related to sexual harassment and related issues.
- Ensure confidential, fair, and impartial enquiry procedures.

- Provide counseling and emotional support to affected individuals.
- Recommend preventive, corrective, and disciplinary measures when necessary.
- Organize seminars, workshops, self-defense programs, and counseling sessions.
- Invite legal experts, doctors, counselors, and resource persons to address women-related issues.
- Promote gender sensitization and respectful behavior on campus.
- Maintain records and reports of all activities and proceedings.

6. Complaint Redressal Procedure

Step 1: Filing of Complaint

- Any aggrieved woman student or staff member may submit a written complaint to the ICC.
- Complaints may be submitted in person, through email, or via complaint box.
- The complaint should preferably be submitted within the prescribed timeframe as per rules.

Step 2: Registration of Complaint

- The complaint shall be confidentially registered and acknowledged.
- Confidentiality of the complainant and proceedings shall be strictly maintained.

Step 3: Preliminary Review

- The committee shall examine the complaint and determine the nature of the issue.
- If required, preliminary counseling or mediation may be attempted where appropriate and permissible.

Step 4: Enquiry Process

- The ICC shall conduct a fair and impartial enquiry.
- Both complainant and respondent shall be given opportunity to present their case.
- Evidence, statements, and relevant documents may be collected.

Step 5: Recommendations and Action

Based on the findings, the committee may recommend:

- Counseling
- Warning or apology
- Community service
- Suspension or disciplinary action
- Referral to higher authorities or legal agencies if necessary

Step 6: Communication and Follow-Up

- The findings and recommendations shall be communicated confidentially to the concerned parties and management.
- Necessary follow-up action shall be monitored by the committee.

7. Preventive Measures

The institution shall take measures to:

- Display awareness posters and guidelines on campus.
- Conduct gender sensitization programs regularly.
- Ensure safe campus facilities and grievance mechanisms.
- Encourage respectful and ethical behavior among students and staff.
- Promote equal opportunity and dignity for women.

8. Support and Welfare Activities

The committee may organize:

- Health and hygiene awareness programs
- Counseling sessions
- Legal literacy programs
- Self-defense training
- Mental wellness programs
- Guest lectures by doctors, counselors, advocates, and women welfare experts

9. Confidentiality

- All complaints, records, enquiry proceedings, and decisions shall remain strictly confidential.
- Disclosure of sensitive information without authorization shall invite disciplinary action.

10. Meetings

- The ICC shall conduct regular meetings and emergency meetings whenever required.
- Minutes of meetings and Action Taken Reports shall be maintained properly.

11. Documentation and Records

The committee shall maintain:

- Committee Constitution
- Complaint Register
- Enquiry Reports
- Minutes of Meetings
- Action Taken Reports
- Awareness Program Reports
- Attendance and Photographs
- Annual Reports and Supporting Documents

12. UGC & NAAC Compliance

The Internal Complaints Committee functions in alignment with:

- UGC Regulations on Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal of Sexual Harassment
- Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (POSH) Act, 2013
- NAAC Quality Framework
- Institutional Gender Equity Policies

The committee contributes to:

- Women Safety and Security
- Gender Equity and Inclusiveness

- Student and Staff Welfare
- Ethical Institutional Practices
- Good Governance and Accountability

13. Expected Outcomes

The activities of the ICC are expected to:

- Ensure a safe and secure campus environment.
- Promote gender sensitivity and mutual respect.
- Prevent sexual harassment and discrimination.
- Encourage women empowerment and confidence.
- Strengthen institutional support systems for women.

14. Conclusion

St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur is committed to providing a safe, respectful, and inclusive educational environment for all women students and employees. The Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) / Anti-Sexual Harassment Committee plays a vital role in safeguarding dignity, ensuring justice, and promoting gender equality within the institution.